



Louise Thomson  
THE PLAYBOOK

THE COMPLETE GUIDE · 2026

CREATOR · SOCIAL MEDIA MANAGER · BUSINESS OWNER

# The Complete Creator Playbook

Everything I did to go from a 9–5 to a full-time creator and business — written like I'm sat next to you talking you through it. No fluff, no gatekeeping.

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## START HERE

# Read this first (properly).

Okay — real talk. I **hated school**. I left with next to no grades, and for years I genuinely worried I'd have to crawl back into education just to make a decent living.

Here's the mad part: I actually **had a following** — but I was posting randomly. No purpose, no plan, no clue how any of it turned into money. Sound familiar? This guide is everything I worked out — the messy way — so you don't have to. It's literally what I did, step by step, to turn a phone and an audience into a real income **without a single qualification**.

*You don't need grades, or to be famous, techy or lucky. You need one skill people pay for, a simple system, and the stubbornness to keep going when it's slow. That's the whole secret.*

## Four rules before we start

- ✦ **Don't just read it.** Reading feels productive — it isn't. Every bit ends with one thing to actually do. Do that thing.
- ✦ **Pick ONE path first.** Creator, social media manager, or your own thing. I tried all three at once and got nowhere — don't be me.
- ✦ **Let it be scrappy.** Your first videos will be bad. Mine were shocking. Post them anyway — that's how you get good.
- ✦ **Keep it close.** The pricing, scripts and checklists — you'll want them the day a client says yes and you slightly panic (you will, it's fine).

**I won't lie to you:** you won't be rich by Friday. But do the things in here and you'll make your first money online — and once you've made £1, £10k is just the same skills on repeat. Right — let's go.



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## WHAT'S INSIDE

# Thirteen modules — the whole industry.

|    |                                 |     |
|----|---------------------------------|-----|
| 01 | Foundations & Mindset           | p4  |
| 02 | Become a Content Creator        | p9  |
| 03 | Stay Safe Online                | p17 |
| 04 | SEO & Getting Found             | p20 |
| 05 | Become a Social Media Manager   | p25 |
| 06 | Build a Social Media Agency     | p31 |
| 07 | Branding That Sells             | p36 |
| 08 | Build Websites (& Sell Them)    | p40 |
| 09 | Pricing — What to Charge        | p44 |
| 10 | Set Up Your Business & Get Paid | p48 |
| 11 | Grow, Monetise & Scale          | p54 |
| 12 | Launch — Your First 90 Days     | p59 |
| 13 | Done For You & AI               | p64 |

**How it flows:** learn to create, stay safe & get found (1–4), turn it into paid client work & an agency (5–6), look professional (7–8), price & set the business up properly (9–10), then grow, launch and scale — with my team and AI behind you (11–13).



A woman with long brown hair, wearing a leopard print dress, is sitting at a bar. She is looking towards the camera with a slight smile. Her right arm is raised, touching her hair. The bar has a marble top and a backlit shelf filled with various liquor bottles. In the background, there are more bottles and a green cushioned chair.

MODULE 01

# Foundations & Mindset

Before any tactics — the opportunity you're walking into, the three ways to actually earn, how to pick your thing, and the number you're aiming at. Get this bit right and the rest is easy.

The opportunity

Your path

Your niche

Your goal



## THE OPPORTUNITY

# You're early, not late.

Everyone tells you "you've missed it, it's too saturated." Rubbish. I hear that every single year — and every single year more people quit their jobs doing this. You're not late. You're early to the rest of your life.

**£0**

To start — you own the kit already

**2–3 hrs**

A day is enough on the side

**Global**

Your market is the whole internet

## Why this actually works right now

- ✦ **Every business needs content and hasn't got a clue.** That gap is literally your income — they'll happily pay you to fix it.
- ✦ **Attention is money.** If you can make someone stop scrolling, you can turn that into cash a dozen different ways.
- ✦ **The tools are free.** The same phone in your hand built my whole business. No studio, no team, no budget.
- ✦ **You start tiny.** One client, one video, one product — then it snowballs. It always starts small.

**Reframe it:** you're not "trying to go viral." You're building a **skill** — content, growth, managing socials — that the market pays for whether you've got 500 followers or 5 million.

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## YOUR PATH

# Three ways to earn — pick one.

There are three routes in. They overlap and honestly I do all three now — but when you're starting, pick **ONE**. Trying all three at once is how you end up doing none properly (been there).



### Content Creator

Grow your own audience, get paid through brand deals, UGC and your own stuff.

If you want a personal brand



### Social Media Manager

Run socials for other businesses for a monthly fee. Money the fastest.

If you want cash soonest



### Business Owner

Package it all — agency, websites, products — into a company.

If you want to scale big

## Which one, honestly?

- ✦ **Need money in 30 days?** Start as a **social media manager**. You can land a paying client before you have any following at all.
- ✦ **Love being on camera?** Start as a **creator**, then add management once you get how the platforms work.
- ✦ **Already got a skill or a following?** Go straight to **business owner** and package it up.

**Do this now:** circle the one that's you today. That's the module you start with — but read the lot, because you'll end up doing more than one.

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## YOUR NICHE

# Get specific — it's how you get paid.

"I'll just post about everything" is the fastest way to grow nothing. I know because I did it. The second I got specific, everything clicked — people knew what I was for, so they followed, and brands knew who to book.

**My little formula: Passion × Skill × Demand.** Something you actually enjoy, something you're half-decent at (or willing to learn), and something people already spend money on. Where those three cross — that's your niche.

## Niches that make money

- ◆ Beauty & skincare
- ◆ Fitness & wellness
- ◆ Fashion & styling
- ◆ Food & recipes
- ◆ Travel & lifestyle
- ◆ Home & interiors
- ◆ Money & business
- ◆ Parenting & family
- ◆ Local businesses (huge for SMM)
- ◆ Tech, gaming & AI

## Now nail it down in one line

Fill this in: **"I help [who] to [what] through [content / social media]."** e.g. "I help busy mums eat well in 15 minutes" or "I help local gyms fill their classes." That one sentence is your whole positioning — it goes in your bio, your pitches, everywhere.

**Do this now:** write your one-liner. If a stranger can't tell what you do from it, make it more specific.

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## YOUR GOAL

# Aim at a real number.

"I want to make money online" isn't a goal, it's a wish. Pick an actual number and work backwards — the internet doesn't cap your income, so the target's yours to set.

### The income ladder (pick your rung)

| Level      | What it looks like                | Monthly          |
|------------|-----------------------------------|------------------|
| Side money | 1 SMM client or a few UGC videos  | £500–£1,000      |
| Part-time  | 2–3 clients or steady brand deals | £1,500–£3,000    |
| Full-time  | Replace the 9–5, streams mixed    | £4,000–£8,000    |
| Scaling    | Agency / products / big deals     | £10,000–£20,000+ |

### Now work backwards

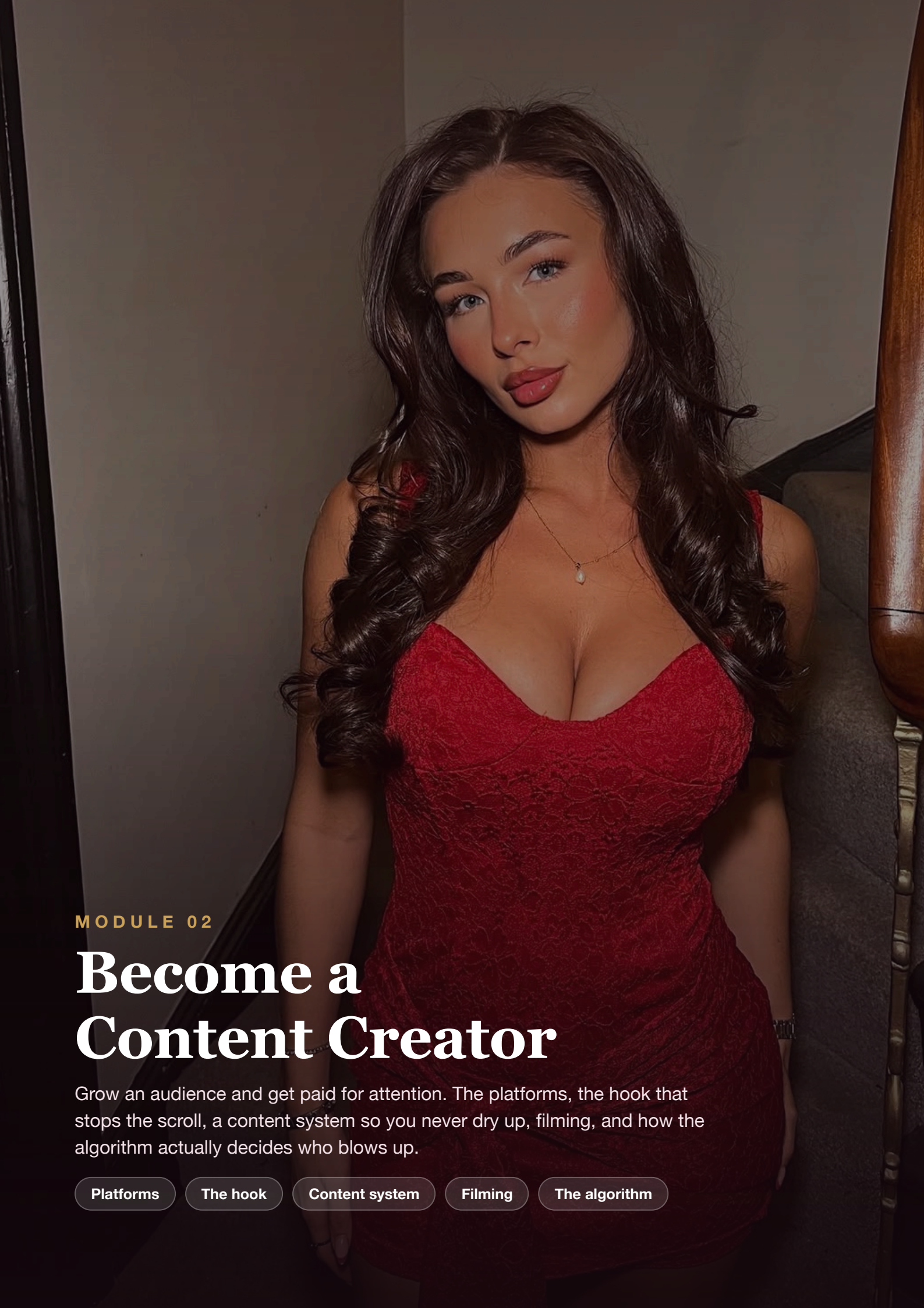
- ✦ Want **£2,000 a month**? That's just **2 clients at £1,000**. Or 8–10 UGC videos. Or one good brand deal a week. Suddenly it's not scary.
- ✦ Break the money into **things you can count** — clients, videos, deals — and chase the **things**, not the money. The money follows.

### Your income is a decision, not a wage.

Nobody's giving you a raise. Here, you give yourself one — you add a client, a stream, or you put your prices up.

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MODULE 02

# Become a Content Creator

Grow an audience and get paid for attention. The platforms, the hook that stops the scroll, a content system so you never dry up, filming, and how the algorithm actually decides who blows up.

Platforms

The hook

Content system

Filming

The algorithm

## THE ROLE

# What the job actually is.

A creator does two things: makes stuff people want to watch, and builds trust with the people watching. That's it. Everything else — deals, sales, clients — comes off the back of those two.

## Where to post (and why)



### TikTok

Fastest growth from zero — it shows new creators to new people. Start here.



### Instagram

Where brands look and money lives. Reels for reach, feed & stories for trust.



### YouTube

Slower, but it compounds — long life and searchable for years.

**Start on ONE** (I'd say TikTok), get good, then repurpose the same content everywhere. One idea → a TikTok, a Reel, a Short, a post. Don't try to be everywhere on day one.

## How TikTok actually pays you

- ♦ **Paid creator opportunities** — brands and TikTok itself pay creators to make content.
- ♦ **Creator Rewards Programme** — get paid for longer, original videos that perform well.
- ♦ **Work with artists** — get paid to feature and push their songs/sounds in your videos.
- ♦ **TikTok Shop** — tag products in your videos and earn commission on every sale.

## Your week, on repeat

- ♦ **Plan** — pull the week's ideas from your pillars (coming up).
- ♦ **Batch** — film a few in one go. 10x more efficient than filming daily.
- ♦ **Post & reply** — answer every comment in the first hour, it tells the app your video's hot.
- ♦ **Review** — see what worked, do more of that. Simple.

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Want more, or want it done for you? [DM @lou1sethompson](#)

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## THE HOOK SYSTEM

# The first 2 seconds are everything.

Here's the truth nobody wants to hear: right now, nobody cares about your video. You've got about **two seconds** before the thumb keeps scrolling — and if you don't stop them there, it doesn't matter how good the rest is, because no one sees it. So we obsess over those two seconds. This one skill changed everything for me.

### How to write a hook that actually stops people

- 1 Lead with the result or the drama — never the setup**  
Bin "hey guys so today I wanted to talk about..." (instant scroll). Open with "I made £2,000 from one video — here's exactly how."
- 2 Put the promise on screen in frame one**  
People watch on mute. If they can read what they'll get in the first second, they stay. Big text, top third.
- 3 Open a loop — don't give the answer yet**  
"The third one is the reason I blew up..." Their brain needs to close the loop, so they keep watching.

### Steal these — fill in the blanks

- ♦ "Stop **[mistake]** if you want **[result]**."
- ♦ "Nobody tells you this about **[topic]**..."
- ♦ "I tried **[thing]** for 30 days — here's what happened."
- ♦ "How I went from **[before]** to **[after]**."

**My actual process:** I write 10 hooks before I film anything. I bin 7. I film the 3 that make even *me* want to watch. Weak hook? I don't post it. No hook, no post.

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## CONTENT SYSTEM

# Never run out of ideas.

Consistency beats everything, and the thing that kills consistency is sitting there going "what do I even post today?" A simple system fixes that forever. Mine is pillars + a set week.

### Step 1 — pick 3–5 pillars

Pillars are the themes you always post about. Example for a fitness page: **Educate** (tips, myths), **Inspire** (wins, transformations), **Relate** (day-in-the-life, struggles), **Sell** (your offer). Everything you post is one of these.

**The 3:1 rule:** for every 3 posts that give value, 1 can sell. Give way more than you ask for and people happily buy when you do ask.

### Step 2 — set a repeatable week

| Day | Pillar       | Format                         |
|-----|--------------|--------------------------------|
| Mon | Educate      | Quick talking-head tip         |
| Wed | Relate       | Day-in-the-life                |
| Fri | Inspire      | A result / story               |
| Sun | Sell / trend | Your offer or a trending sound |

**Do this now:** write your 4 pillars, then batch-film one video for each in a single 90-minute session. That's your whole week done.

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## FILMING & EDITING

# Make it look pro on a phone.

You do not need a fancy camera — honestly, the camera on your phone is **pretty good**, better than you think. I still film everything on mine. You need three things: decent light, clear sound, clean edits. That's the whole game.

### The £0–£100 kit

- ✦ **Your phone** — the camera's plenty good
- ✦ **A window** or a cheap ring light
- ✦ **A phone tripod** (~£15)
- ✦ **A clip mic** for talking videos (~£25)

### Free editing apps

- ✦ **CapCut** — the industry standard, free
- ✦ **InShot** — quick and simple
- ✦ Or edit in-app and post natively

### My editing checklist (every video)

- ✓ **Captions on** — most people watch on mute.
- ✓ **Cut every pause** — trim the dead air, keep it snappy.
- ✓ **Hook text in the first frame.**
- ✓ **Trending or clean audio.**
- ✓ **Vertical, full screen** — 9:16, no borders.

**Real talk:** done beats perfect, every time. Your 50th video will be miles better than your first — so get to your 50th fast. Stop overthinking one video.

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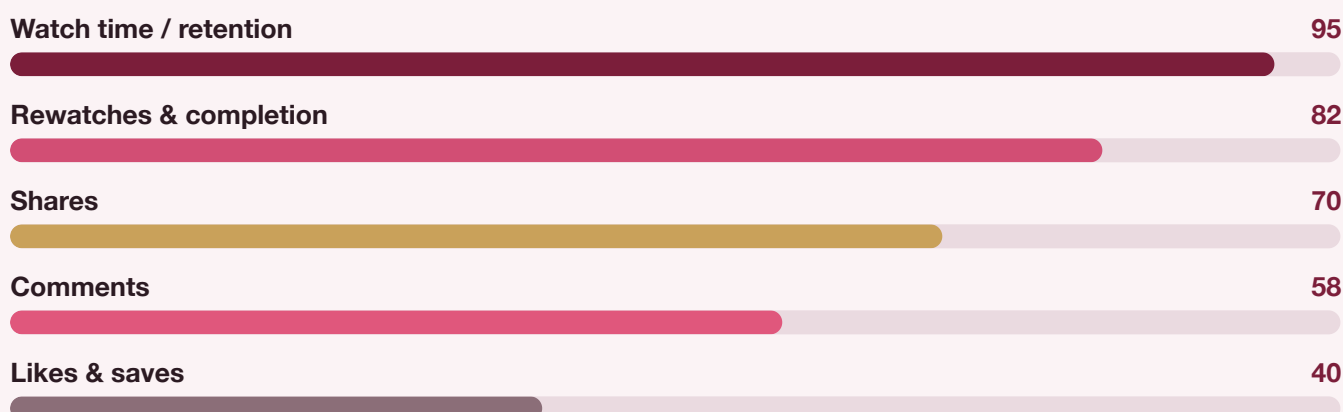


## THE ALGORITHM

# How you actually blow up.

The algorithm isn't magic and it isn't out to get you. It shows your video to a small test group, watches how they react, and pushes the winners to more people. Your whole job is to win that first little test.

### The signals that matter (in order)



- ✦ **Hook for retention** — the longer they watch, the more it spreads. Everything comes back to watch time.
- ✦ **Make it shareable** — a share is the strongest signal. Give people a reason to send it to a mate.
- ✦ **Make it savable** — **educational and informative** videos get **saved**, and the platform pushes content people save and come back to.
- ✦ **Reply to comments fast** — early engagement tells it your video's hot.
- ✦ **Post consistently** — 1× a day beats 7× on Monday then nothing.
- ✦ **Ride trends early** — trending sounds and formats get a boost.

**Don't chase followers — chase reach.** Views bring the followers, the deals and the clients. One video really can change your life; I've had **18.3M views on a single post**.

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## IDEAS & REPURPOSING

# One idea, a whole week.

Two things kill people: running out of ideas, and burning out making them. Here's the bank I pull from, and how I turn one idea into a week of content so I'm not filming every single day.

### 10 ideas that always work

- ◆ How-to / tutorial
- ◆ Common mistakes in your niche
- ◆ Myth vs truth
- ◆ Day in the life
- ◆ Before & after
- ◆ "Things I wish I knew"
- ◆ Answer a follower question
- ◆ A product/tool you love
- ◆ Story time (a lesson)
- ◆ A trend, done your way

### Turn 1 idea into 5 posts

**1 Pick one topic**  
e.g. "how I plan a week of content."

**2 Chop it up**  
The quick tip, the full how-to, the mistake to avoid, a result, a Q&A.

**3 Reformat**  
Video, carousel, story, a written post, an email — same idea, five places.

**Do this now:** start a notes list called "content ideas" and dump every idea into it the second it hits you. You'll never open the app with nothing to say again.

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## BUILD YOUR PORTFOLIO

# Proof you can point to.

Your portfolio is the "here's what I can do" you send to brands and clients. You don't need a fancy website to start — a clean folder of your best work does the job, and it's what turns a chat into a booking.

## What goes in it

- ✦ **Your best 6–10 pieces** — the ones you're proudest of, not everything.
- ✦ **Any results** — views, saves, sales, "this hit 200k." Numbers sell.
- ✦ **Any brands you've worked with** — even small or unpaid ones count.
- ✦ **A short bio + what you offer** and how to book you.

## Where to keep it

- ✦ **A one-page media kit** (free in Canva) — perfect for brand pitches.
- ✦ **A shared folder or link-in-bio** (Google Drive, Stan, Beacons) — send it in seconds.
- ✦ Later, a simple **website** (Module 08) — but don't wait for that to start.

**Do this now:** screenshot your 6 best pieces into one folder today. That's a portfolio — you can make it pretty later. Having one is what matters.

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A close-up portrait of a woman with long, wavy brown hair and blue eyes, sitting in the driver's seat of a car. She is wearing a white collared shirt and a dark jacket. The car's interior, including the leather seat and a sunroof, is visible in the background.

MODULE 03

# Stay Safe Online

Putting yourself out there is brilliant — do it. But it's a big world and you don't know who's watching. This is the bit no one warns you about, so I will: simple habits that keep you safe and let you enjoy it for years.

Never show your address

Watch your background

Lock your accounts

Your peace first



## THE RISKS

# It's a big bad world.

I want you to put yourself out there — genuinely. But please read this first. You have **no idea** who's on the other side of the screen, and a few daft slips can put your safety at risk. This isn't to scare you off — it's so you can do this for years without a worry.

### Never give away where you live

- ✦ **Unboxing videos are the classic trap.** So many creators film the parcel with their **full name and address** on it, or their front door, street sign, or the view out the window. Blur it, peel the label off, or film it somewhere else.
- ✦ **Post the trip *after* you're home.** "I'm away in Dubai!" also tells people **your house is empty**. Share the holiday when you're back.
- ✦ **Watch the background** — school uniforms, car number plates, your gym's name, local landmarks and street signs all quietly give your location away.
- ✦ **Be careful with live location** — "come on my morning run with me" can hand a stranger your exact route and time.

**The rule:** share your **world**, not your **whereabouts**. People can feel close to you without knowing where to find you.

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## LOCK IT DOWN

# Your accounts & your peace.

Two jobs here: keep the bad actors **out of your accounts**, and protect your **headspace** from the few who slip through. Both matter — you can't create well if you don't feel safe.

### Secure your accounts

- ✦ **Two-factor authentication** on every account — this alone stops most hacks.
- ✦ **Strong, different passwords** — a password manager makes it easy.
- ✦ **Separate personal and public** — keep a private profile for real friends and family.
- ✦ **Watch for scam "brand deal" DMs** — dodgy links and "pay a fee to get paid" are how creators get phished. Real brands don't work like that.

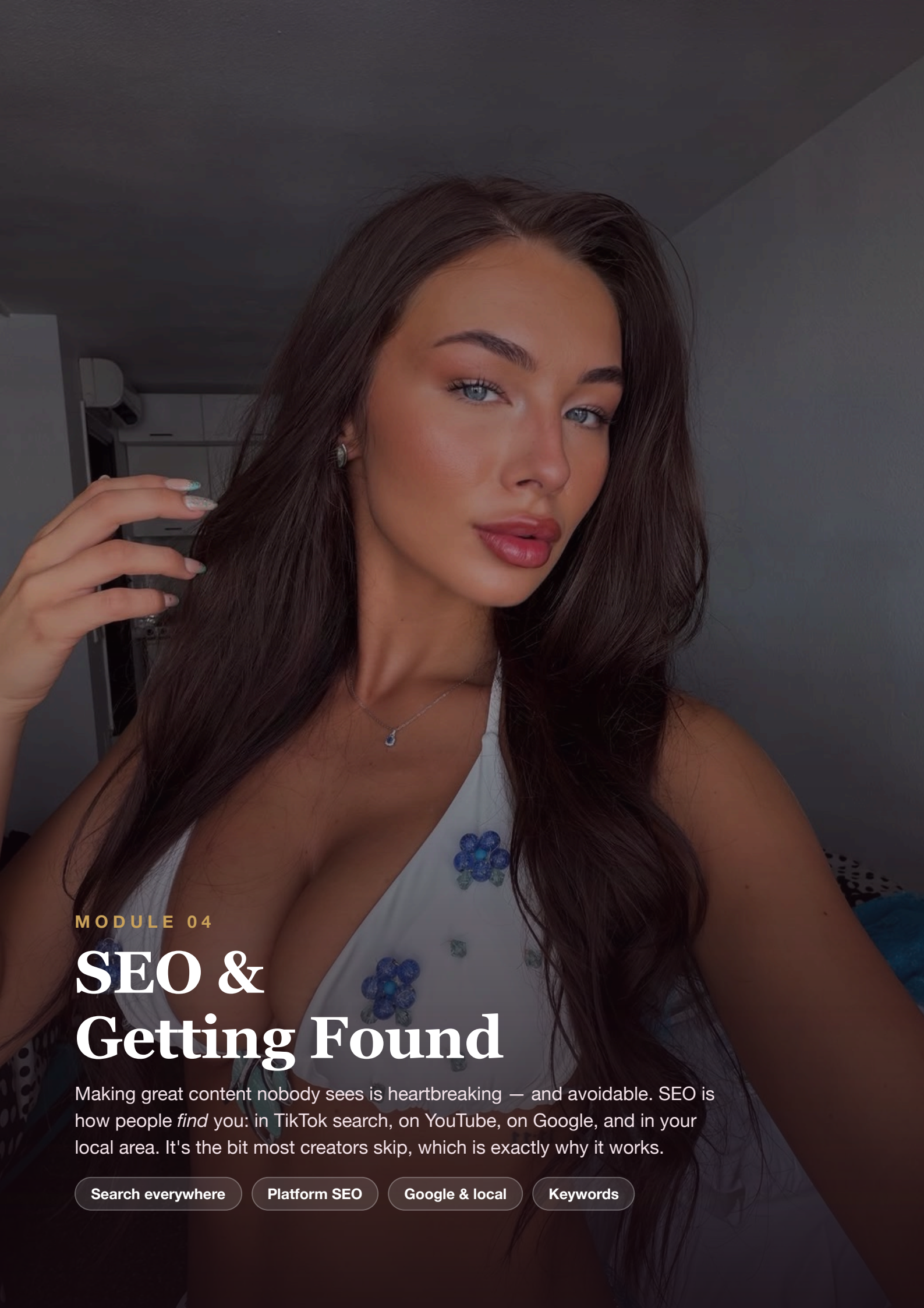
### Protect your peace

- ✦ **Block, mute and report freely** — no guilt, ever. Your peace comes first.
- ✦ **You don't have to read every comment** — filter comments, hide words, turn off DMs from strangers.
- ✦ **It's a job — log off.** Your phone doesn't come to bed with you. Protect your time and your head.

**Do this now:** turn on 2FA on every account and set up your private/public split. Five minutes today saves a world of stress later.

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MODULE 04

# SEO & Getting Found

Making great content nobody sees is heartbreaking — and avoidable. SEO is how people *find* you: in TikTok search, on YouTube, on Google, and in your local area. It's the bit most creators skip, which is exactly why it works.

Search everywhere

Platform SEO

Google & local

Keywords



## WHY SEO

# Get found, not just seen.

Most creators only think about the feed. The smart ones think about **search** too. Every day millions of people search TikTok, YouTube and Google for exactly what you do — SEO puts you in front of them on autopilot, months after you posted.

## Feed vs search — why search wins long-term

- ✦ **Feed content** spikes then dies in about 48 hours.
- ✦ **Search content** keeps getting found for months and years — it stacks up.
- ✦ **Intent is higher** — someone searching "best gym in Glasgow" is ready to buy, not just scrolling.

## The 3 layers of getting found



### Platform search

Ranking inside TikTok, Instagram & YouTube search.



### Google & web

Your site & YouTube showing on Google.



### Local

Getting found by people near you — gold for clients.



Want a keyword plan for your niche or a client's business? **DM @lou1sethomson.**

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Want more, or want it done for you? **DM @lou1sethomson**

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## PLATFORM SEO

# Rank inside the apps.

TikTok, Instagram and YouTube are search engines now — people literally use them like Google. Here's how to rank so your content keeps getting found long after you post.

### The rules that apply everywhere

- ✦ **Say your keyword out loud** in the first few seconds — the apps transcribe your audio and file the video by it.
- ✦ **Put the keyword in your on-screen text AND caption.**
- ✦ **Use words people actually type** — "high-protein breakfast", not "yummy morning fuel."

| App              | Ranks on                       | Do this                          |
|------------------|--------------------------------|----------------------------------|
| <b>TikTok</b>    | Spoken words, captions, tags   | Keyword in line 1 + say it       |
| <b>Instagram</b> | Captions, name field, alt text | Keywords in caption & name       |
| <b>YouTube</b>   | Title, description, tags       | Keyword title + full description |

**Sneaky tip:** your Instagram **name field** (not your @handle) is searchable. Put your niche there — "Ella · Glasgow Content & Social" — and you'll show up when people search it.

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## GOOGLE & LOCAL

# Own Google & your area.

A website plus a Google presence makes you look real and gets you found by people ready to hire. And local SEO? That's a goldmine if you're chasing local clients as a social media manager.

## Website SEO basics

- ✦ **One keyword per page** — in the title, the first heading, and the URL.
- ✦ **Write for humans first**, then slot keywords in naturally.
- ✦ **Fast & mobile** — Google ranks quick, mobile-friendly sites higher.

## Local SEO (clients love this)

- ✦ **Google Business Profile** — free, and it sticks a business on the map. Setting these up is a paid service you can offer.
- ✦ **Reviews** — more 5-stars = higher local ranking.
- ✦ **Local keywords** — "[service] in [town]" across the site and posts.

**Easy money idea:** offer local businesses a "get found on Google" package — profile setup, a reviews system, local content. £300–£800, and most owners have no idea how to do it.

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## KEYWORDS & HASHTAGS

# Words that get you found.

Keywords and hashtags are how the apps understand what your content is and who to show it to. Use them on purpose, not randomly slapped on the end.

### Find your keywords (free, 5 mins)

- ✦ **Type into the search bar** — the autocomplete suggestions are literally what people search. Gold.
- ✦ **Check "others searched for"** under the results.
- ✦ **Read your comments** — the questions people ask ARE keywords.
- ✦ **Use TikTok "Creator Search Insights"** — search that exact phrase in the app. It takes you to a page showing **exactly what people are searching for right now** and the content they're looking for. Make videos that answer it — instant, proven ideas.

### The hashtag formula

- ✦ **3–5 focused tags** beat 30 random ones.
- ✦ **Mix the sizes** — 1 big, 2 medium (your niche), 1 small/branded.
- ✦ **Make a branded hashtag** that's yours alone — so your world's easy to find.

**Captions are SEO too.** Open with your keyword, write a real sentence a human would search, then your call to action. Half my "views" come from search, not the feed.

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MODULE 05

# Become a Social Media Manager

The fastest way to real money — honestly. You don't need a following, you need a service and a system. This module is find clients, pitch them, close them, deliver like a pro, and keep them paying you every month.

The services

Find clients

Pitch & close

Deliver

Keep them



## THE ROLE

# Get paid to run their socials.

Here's the bit people miss: you can earn as a social media manager **with zero followers of your own**. Businesses know they need social media and have no time or clue. You run it for them for a monthly fee. Recurring, reliable money — my favourite kind.

## What you actually offer

- ✦ **Content** — posts, reels, stories
- ✦ **Scheduling & posting**
- ✦ **Captions & hashtags**
- ✦ **Replying to comments & DMs**
- ✦ **Strategy & a plan**
- ✦ **Filming days** at their place
- ✦ **Paid ads** (add-on, more money)
- ✦ **A monthly report**

**They pay for the outcome** — more customers, a page that looks legit — **not your personal follower count**. So don't wait until you're "big enough." You're ready now.

## Who to go after first

- ✦ **Local businesses** — gyms, salons, cafés, dentists, trades, restaurants.
- ✦ **Small brands** posting rubbish or nothing.
- ✦ **Coaches & service people** — great at their thing, hopeless at posting.

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## FIND CLIENTS

# Where they're hiding.

You don't need hundreds of leads. You need a handful of the right conversations. Here's exactly where to look and how to open the door without being cringe.

## Where to find them

- ✦ **Instagram search** — local businesses with dead or ugly pages. That's your opening line right there.
- ✦ **Google Maps** — every business near you, loads with no socials linked.
- ✦ **Your own network** — your fastest first client is someone who already knows you.
- ✦ **Local Facebook groups** — small business owners live in there.

## The DM that actually works

**Lead with value, not a pitch.** Point out one thing you'd improve, or send a free idea. Make it about them, not you.

"Hi [name], love what you do at [business]! I put together a couple of quick content ideas that could bring you more [bookings/customers] — want me to send them over? No strings, I just work with local businesses like yours."

- ✦ **Follow up twice.** Most yeses are in the follow-up, not the first message.
- ✦ **Aim for a call, not a sale,** in the DM. You sell on the call.

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## PITCH & CLOSE

# Turn a chat into a client.

On the call you're not begging for work. You're a professional looking at their problem and telling them the fix. Confidence closes — and this simple structure does the heavy lifting.

- 1 Ask & listen**  
"What are you hoping to get from social media?" Let them talk. Their words become your pitch.
- 2 Say the gap back to them**  
"So you want more bookings, but you're posting twice a month with no plan."
- 3 Offer ONE package**  
One clear package, one monthly price. Don't drown them in options.
- 4 Frame the price as ROI**  
"One new customer a month covers this — and I'll aim for a lot more than one."
- 5 Close it**  
"Shall we start Monday? I'll send everything over." Then stop talking.

**The secret:** say your price, then shut up. Whoever speaks first "loses" — let them sit with it. You're solving a real problem; act like it.

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## DELIVER LIKE A PRO

# Run it like a machine.

Winning the client is the hard bit. Keeping them is easy if you set it up properly from day one. Here's my exact onboarding and monthly flow.

### Onboarding checklist (do all of it)

- ✓ **Contract signed** & first invoice paid **before** any work.
- ✓ **Access** — added as a manager (never post from your own login).
- ✓ **Brand basics** — logo, colours, fonts, tone, do's & don'ts.
- ✓ **Month-one content plan** approved.
- ✓ **A filming day** booked to bank a batch of content.

### The monthly flow

| Week | What you do                                  |
|------|----------------------------------------------|
| 1    | Plan the month, film/gather, get it approved |
| 2–3  | Schedule & post, manage comments & DMs       |
| 4    | Engage, check numbers, plan next month       |
| End  | Send the report, invoice for next month      |

**Batch across clients:** all planning on one day, all editing on another. Systems are how you handle 5+ clients without losing your mind.

LT





## KEEP THEM

# Results = they never leave.

A client who stays is money every single month with no re-selling. The two things that keep them: showing results, and communicating so they never wonder what they're paying for.

### The monthly report (keep it simple)

- ✦ **Reach & views** — up or down vs last month.
- ✦ **Follower growth** & engagement.
- ✦ **Best posts** — what worked and why.
- ✦ **Leads / bookings / clicks** — the number they actually care about.
- ✦ **Next month's plan** — always end looking forward.

**Over-communicate.** A quick weekly "here's what's going out this week" message makes clients feel looked after — and stops them ever questioning the invoice.

### Then grow the account (and the invoice)

- ✦ Once you're delivering, **upsell**: ads, a second platform, a filming day, a website.
- ✦ Ask happy clients for a **testimonial and a referral** — your next clients come from your current ones.



Want my client report template & onboarding checklist? **DM @lou1sethomson.**

LT



A woman with long brown hair and blue eyes, wearing a black polka-dot crop top with a white bow at the waist and a matching skirt, stands against a rough stone wall. She is looking directly at the camera with a slight smile. The lighting is warm and focused on her, creating a soft glow. The background shows the texture of the stone wall and a dark wooden structure on the right.

MODULE 06

# Build a Social Media Agency

When you're maxed out on clients, you don't work more hours — you build a company. Systems, a small team, delivery that runs without you. This is how a freelancer becomes an agency owner who earns while they sleep.

Freelancer → agency

Systems

Hire a team

Scale delivery





FREELANCER → AGENCY

# From doing it to owning it.

A freelancer sells their hours. An agency sells an outcome and delivers it with a team and systems. That's how you smash through the "there aren't enough hours" ceiling — and it's simpler than it sounds.

## The 4 stages

1

### Solo

You do everything for 1–3 clients. Prove you get results.

2

### Systemised

You turn how you work into repeatable processes.

3

### Small team

You outsource tasks — editing first, then posting — and manage instead of do.

4

### Agency

A team delivers, you sell & lead. 10+ clients, real profit.

**Niche the agency.** "Social media for gyms" beats "for anyone." You get referrals, reuse ideas across clients, and charge more as the specialist.



Building an agency and want a shortcut? **DM @lou1sethomson** — it's exactly what we help creators set up.

LT



Want more, or want it done for you? **DM @lou1sethomson**

LOUISE THOMSON · THE PLAYBOOK · 32



## SYSTEMS & SOPS

# Make yourself replaceable.

Systems are what let you hand work over without the quality dropping. Every time you do a task, write down how you did it — that's an SOP, and it's the backbone of a business that can run without you glued to it.

### The core systems to build

- ✦ **Onboarding** — the exact steps from "yes" to first post.
- ✦ **Content production** — plan → film → edit → approve → schedule.
- ✦ **Reporting** — one template, filled in monthly.
- ✦ **Communication** — when and how you update clients.

### Tools that run the machine

- ✦ **Notion / Trello / ClickUp** — your client & content hub.
- ✦ **Later / Metricool** — schedule without logging in daily.
- ✦ **Google Drive** — every client's content, organised.
- ✦ **Loom** — record how you do a thing once, train anyone off it.

**My rule:** if I've done it twice, I write the SOP. Boring for an afternoon, life-changing forever.

LT





## HIRE YOUR TEAM

# Buy back your time.

You can't scale on your own — and you don't have to. You hire in the right order, starting with the tasks you hate, and each hire pays for themselves by freeing you up to win more clients.

## Who to hire, in order

| Hire                        | Takes over             | Rough cost          |
|-----------------------------|------------------------|---------------------|
| 1. <b>Video editor</b>      | The biggest time-drain | £5–£20 / video      |
| 2. <b>Virtual assistant</b> | Scheduling, DMs, admin | £4–£12 / hour       |
| 3. <b>Filmer/creator</b>    | Client filming days    | Per day / freelance |
| 4. <b>Account manager</b>   | Running clients daily  | Salary / %          |

## Where to find them

- ✦ **Upwork, Fiverr, OnlineJobs.ph** — freelancers & VAs.
- ✦ **Instagram/TikTok** — hire editors whose work you already rate.
- ✦ **Your own audience** — your followers often want to work with you.

**Hire freelance first.** Start per-task, never salaried. Add hours as the client list grows — never the other way round.

LT





## SCALE DELIVERY

# Quality with 10+ clients.

The danger as you grow is quality slipping. Systems plus batching keep every client feeling like your only client — even when you've got twenty.

### Batch everything

- ✦ **Theme your days** — Mon plan all clients, Tue film, Wed edit, Thu schedule, Fri engage & report.
- ✦ **Templatise** — reuse formats and structures across clients (not the actual content).
- ✦ **Schedule a month ahead** so nothing's ever last-minute.

### Keep them happy at scale

- ✦ **Same-day replies** — speed feels like care.
- ✦ **Monthly report + a quick Loom** walking them through it.
- ✦ **One surprise extra a month** — under-promise, over-deliver.

**10 clients × £1,000 = £10k/month — mostly delivered by your team.**

That's the whole point of an agency: your income stops being tied to your hours.

LT





MODULE 07

# Branding That Sells

People buy from brands they trust. This is how to build a look and a voice — for you and for your clients — that feels premium, gets remembered, and lets you charge more.

Foundations

Visual identity

Voice & positioning



## FOUNDATIONS

# A brand is a feeling.

Your brand is what people feel when they see your name. Get the fundamentals right and you become memorable, recommendable and premium — which means you get to charge more.

### The five foundations

- ✦ **Purpose** — what you stand for and who you help.
- ✦ **Personality** — bold? warm? luxe? playful? expert?
- ✦ **Promise** — the result people get from you.
- ✦ **Look** — colours, fonts, imagery (next page).
- ✦ **Voice** — how you sound in captions and DMs.

**Consistency is the whole trick.** Same colours, same tone, same energy everywhere. Repetition builds recognition, and recognition builds trust — and trust is what people actually pay for.

*People don't buy the best product. They buy the brand they trust the most.*

**Do this now:** write three words for how you want people to feel about you. Everything you make should match them.

LT





## VISUAL IDENTITY

# Your look, locked in.

A simple, consistent look makes you seem established even on day one. You only need a few decisions — then you repeat them forever and never think about it again.

### Colours

- ✦ Pick **1 main, 1 accent, 1–2 neutrals**.
- ✦ Same ones across posts, highlights, your site.
- ✦ Colour = instant recognition in a busy feed.

### Fonts

- ✦ One characterful **heading** font.
- ✦ One clean **body** font.
- ✦ Never more than two — more looks messy.

### The starter brand kit

- ✓ **Logo / wordmark** — even just your name in your font.
- ✓ **Colour palette** — hex codes saved.
- ✓ **2 fonts** — heading + body.
- ✓ **Profile photo & highlight covers** — on brand.
- ✓ **2 reusable post templates**.

**Tool tip:** build the whole kit free in **Canva** and save it as a Brand Kit, so every design you ever make stays consistent automatically.

LT





## VOICE & POSITIONING

# Sound worth following.

Your words do as much as your visuals. A clear voice and a sharp bio turn a random profile-visit into a follow — or an enquiry.

### Find your voice

- ✦ Write like you **talk** — read it out loud; if it sounds stiff, rewrite it.
- ✦ Pick a lane: warm & relatable, bold & direct, or calm & expert.
- ✦ Be consistent so people can "hear" you.

### The bio formula

**[Who you help] + [what you help them do] + [proof/personality] + [one CTA].**

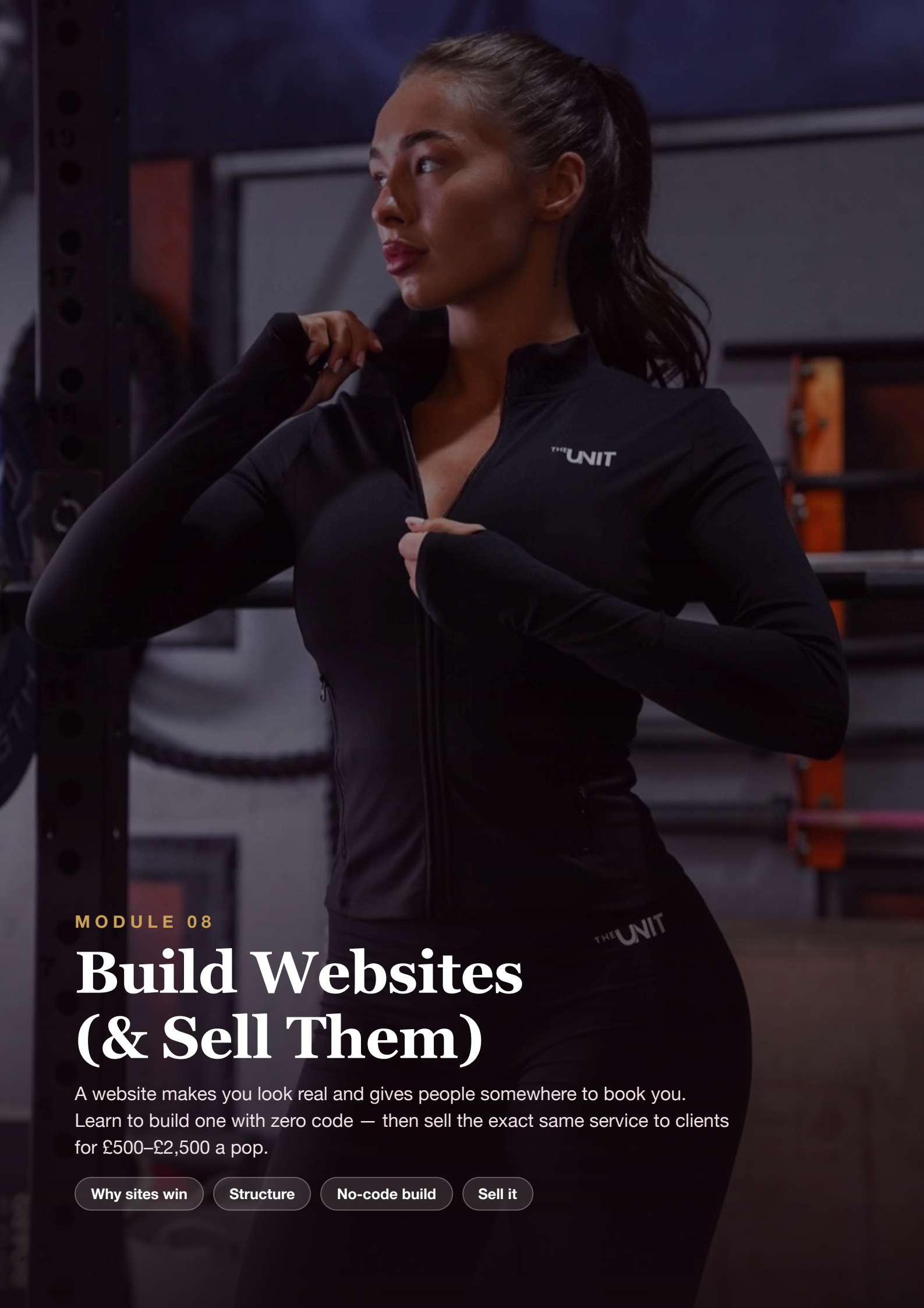
e.g. "Helping local gyms fill classes with scroll-stopping content 💪 300k+ views for clients · DM 'GROW'."

### Be the obvious choice

- ✦ **Niche + result** beats "I do social media." Specific gets booked.
- ✦ **Show proof** the moment you have any — results, testimonials, before/after.
- ✦ **One clear next step** everywhere (follow, DM a word, tap the link).

LT





MODULE 08

# Build Websites (& Sell Them)

A website makes you look real and gives people somewhere to book you.  
Learn to build one with zero code — then sell the exact same service to clients  
for £500–£2,500 a pop.

Why sites win

Structure

No-code build

Sell it



## WHY & WHAT

# Every brand needs a home.

Social media is rented land — the platform owns it and the rules change overnight. A website is land you **own**. It's where people book you, buy from you, and take you seriously — and it's a service you can sell to every single client.

## What a good site does

- ✦ **Builds trust** — a real site says "real business."
- ✦ **Captures leads** — enquiry forms, email sign-ups.
- ✦ **Sells 24/7** — services, products, bookings.
- ✦ **Shows proof** — portfolio, testimonials, results.

## The pages nearly every site needs

| Page            | Its job                                 |
|-----------------|-----------------------------------------|
| Home            | Hook, what you do, proof, one clear CTA |
| About           | Story & trust — why you                 |
| Services / Shop | What they buy & the next step           |
| Portfolio       | Results & testimonials                  |
| Contact / Book  | Form, calendar, socials                 |

**One golden rule:** every page points to ONE clear action — book, buy, or enquire. Confused people don't buy.

LT





## BUILD IT (NO CODE)

# Live in a weekend.

You do not need to code. Modern drag-and-drop builders mean anyone can make a beautiful, professional site. Here's the exact workflow.

### Pick a builder

#### Wix / Squarespace

Easiest for beginners. Gorgeous templates, drag-and-drop, hosting built in.

#### Framer / Carrd

Sleek & modern. Carrd is perfect (and cheap) for one-pagers.

#### Shopify

When they're selling products.

### The build steps

#### 1 Start from a template

Pick one close to the vibe — never start from blank.

#### 2 Swap in the brand

Colours, fonts, logo, photos, real words.

#### 3 Write clear copy

Benefit-led headlines, short paragraphs, buttons everywhere.

#### 4 Connect the essentials

Domain, contact form, socials, booking/payment.

#### 5 Check mobile & launch

Most visitors are on a phone — test it there first.

LT





## SELL IT

# Turn it into £500–£2,500.

Once you can build one site, you can build them for clients — and it pairs perfectly with social media management. Same clients, extra income, barely any extra effort.

## Website packages

| Package       | Included                              | Price         |
|---------------|---------------------------------------|---------------|
| One-pager     | Single scrolling page, form, socials  | £400–£800     |
| Business site | 4–6 pages, copy, branding, SEO basics | £900–£2,500   |
| Online shop   | Products, payments, setup & training  | £2,500–£6,000 |
| Care plan     | Hosting, updates & edits (recurring)  | £30–£100/mo   |

**The care plan is the gold.** Build it once, then charge monthly to look after it — recurring income sat on top of the build fee.

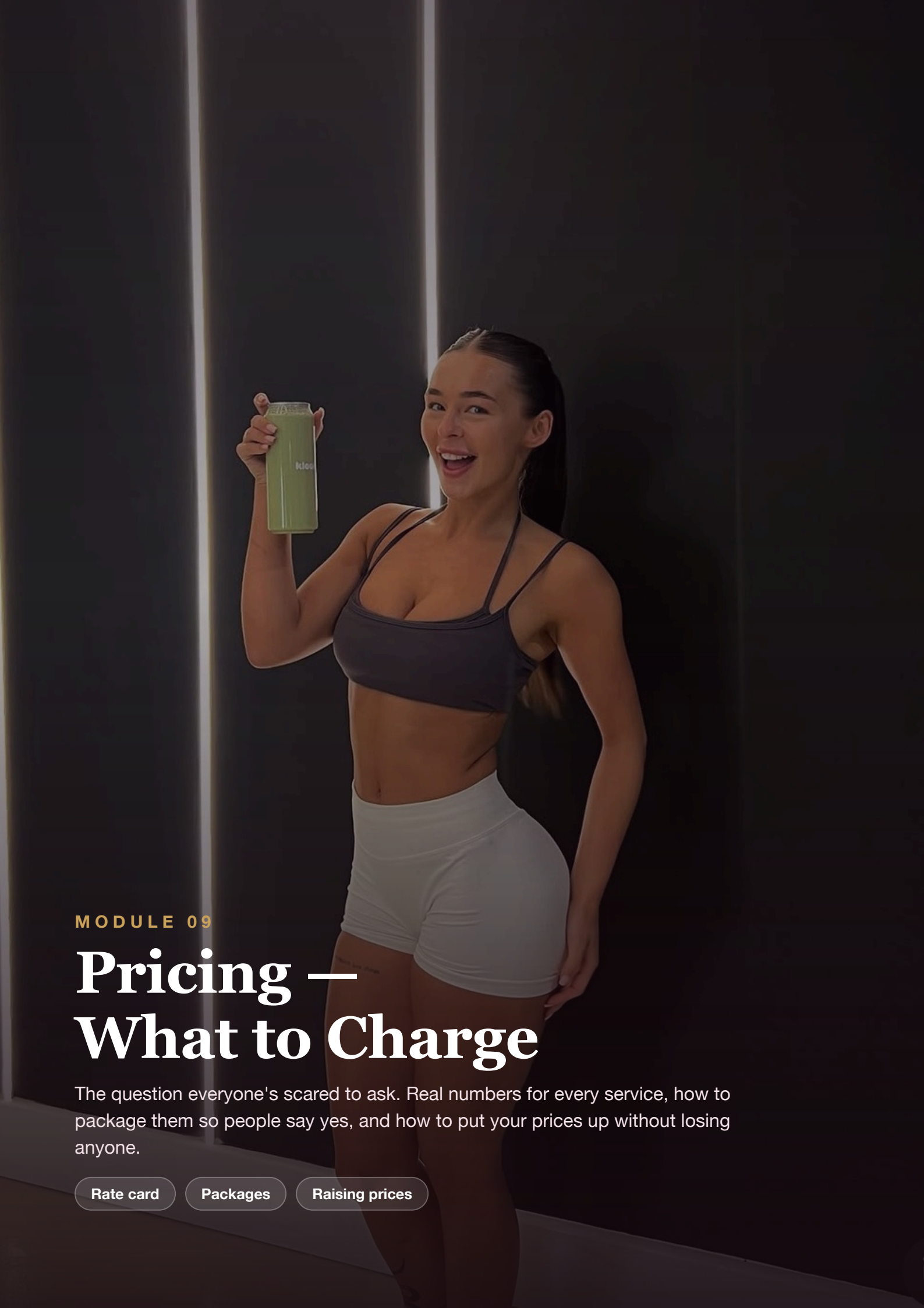
- ✦ **Bundle it:** "Website + social media management" is an easy, high-value yes.
- ✦ **Show, don't tell:** rebuild a local business's weak site as a free demo — it becomes your portfolio and your pitch.



Don't want to build it yourself? My team builds sites for creators & businesses — **DM @lou1sethomson.**

LT



A woman with long dark hair, wearing a dark grey sports bra and white high-waisted shorts, is smiling and holding a green smoothie in a clear bottle. The bottle has the word 'klos' on it. She is standing in front of a dark background with two vertical light streaks.

MODULE 09

# Pricing — What to Charge

The question everyone's scared to ask. Real numbers for every service, how to package them so people say yes, and how to put your prices up without losing anyone.

Rate card

Packages

Raising prices



## THE RATE CARD

# What to actually charge.

Undercharging is the number one mistake — I did it for way too long. Here are real market ranges. Start near the lower end while you build proof, then put them up every few clients (next page).

| Service                      | What it is                       | Price            |
|------------------------------|----------------------------------|------------------|
| <b>SMM — Starter</b>         | 1 platform, ~12 posts/mo         | £400–£600/mo     |
| <b>SMM — Growth</b>          | 2 platforms, reels, engagement   | £800–£1,200/mo   |
| <b>SMM — Premium</b>         | Full management + strategy       | £1,500–£3,000/mo |
| <b>UGC video</b>             | Single branded video             | £120–£300        |
| <b>Brand deal post</b>       | Per platform (scales with reach) | £250–£2,000+     |
| <b>Content / filming day</b> | Batch of photo & video           | £400–£800        |
| <b>Website</b>               | One-pager → business site        | £400–£2,500      |
| <b>Branding kit</b>          | Logo, colours, fonts, templates  | £250–£1,500      |
| <b>Coaching</b>              | Per hour                         | £60–£150/hr      |

**Price on value, not hours.** A post that brings a client £5,000 is worth way more than the 30 minutes it took you. Charge for the result.

LT





## PACKAGES

# Sell outcomes, not tasks.

Never sell "posts." Sell a **package** with a clear outcome and a monthly price. Packages are easier to buy, easier to deliver, and way more profitable.

### Build three tiers

#### Good

The essentials at an easy-yes price. Gets them in.

£400–£600/mo

#### Better

Your main offer — most people pick this.

£800–£1,200/mo

#### Best

Everything done for them. Anchors your pricing.

£1,500–£3,000/mo

**The middle always wins.** Most people choose the middle option — so put your best offer there and price the others around it to make it the obvious value.

### Why retainers change your life

- ♦ **Predictable** — you start every month already earning.
- ♦ **Less selling** — win a client once, get paid for months.
- ♦ **It compounds** — 5 clients at £1,000 = £5,000/mo, every month.

**Do this now:** write your three packages — names, what's in them, prices. Done? You're ready to pitch.

LT





## RAISING PRICES

# Charge more, keep everyone.

Your prices should go up as you get better and busier — but people freeze here, terrified of scaring clients off. Here's how to do it calmly and keep them all.

### When to put prices up

- ✦ **Every few new clients** — new clients come in at the higher rate, existing ones stay (for now).
- ✦ **When you're fully booked** — demand > supply means raise the price, not the hours.
- ✦ **When you've got proof** — results and testimonials justify a higher number.

### How to tell existing clients

"Hi [name], from [date] my rate for this package is moving to £[X]/mo. It reflects the results we've been getting and the extra I've been adding. I'd love to keep working together — happy to talk it through."

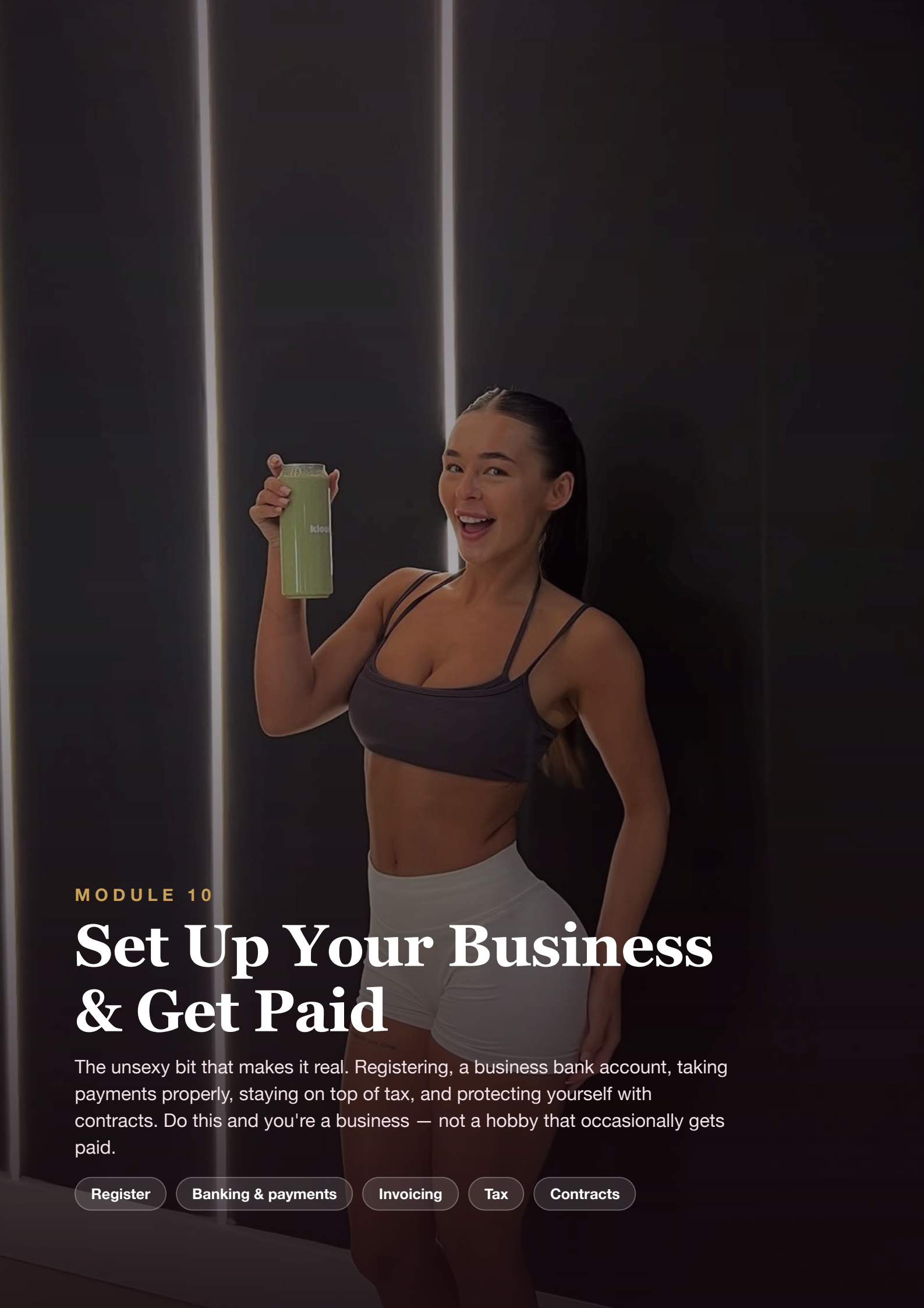
- ✦ **Give notice** (30 days), be calm, don't apologise.
- ✦ Most stay — you're already delivering, and switching is a hassle for them.
- ✦ If one leaves, the higher rate usually makes up for it with fewer clients anyway.

### Charging more attracts BETTER clients.

Cheap attracts nightmares. Higher prices bring people who value the work and cause less hassle. Every time.

LT





## MODULE 10

# Set Up Your Business & Get Paid

The unsexy bit that makes it real. Registering, a business bank account, taking payments properly, staying on top of tax, and protecting yourself with contracts. Do this and you're a business — not a hobby that occasionally gets paid.

[Register](#)[Banking & payments](#)[Invoicing](#)[Tax](#)[Contracts](#)



## REGISTER

# Make it official.

You can start earning today, but once money's coming in you set up properly. It's simpler and cheaper than people fear (this is UK — check your own country's rules).

### Sole trader vs limited company

|                  | Sole trader                      | Ltd company               |
|------------------|----------------------------------|---------------------------|
| <b>Setup</b>     | Register with HMRC, free, 10 min | Companies House (~£50)    |
| <b>Best for</b>  | Starting out, lower income       | Higher income, protection |
| <b>Admin</b>     | Simple — one tax return          | More, an accountant helps |
| <b>Liability</b> | You & the business are one       | Personal assets protected |

**Simple path:** start as a **sole trader** to keep it easy. Switch to a **limited company** once you're earning well (often ~£30k+) — your accountant will tell you when it's worth it.

- ✦ **Pick a name** — yours works fine ("Louise Thomson" / "LT Social").
- ✦ **Register as self-employed** with HMRC.
- ✦ **Don't over-complicate it** — no office, no staff, nothing fancy needed to start.

LT





## BANKING & PAYMENTS

# How to take money properly.

Keep business money separate from personal from day one — it makes tax painless and looks professional. Then set up ways to get paid that people trust and that chase themselves.

### Get a business bank account

- ✦ **Free digital banks** — Starling, Tide, Monzo Business — open from your phone in minutes.
- ✦ **One account for all business in & out** — never mix with personal.

### Ways to get paid

| Method                           | Best for                       | Notes                      |
|----------------------------------|--------------------------------|----------------------------|
| <b>Stripe</b>                    | Cards, invoices, subscriptions | Pro, automatic, small fee  |
| <b>PayPal / Wise</b>             | Quick & international          | Easy, trusted              |
| <b>GoCardless / direct debit</b> | Monthly retainers              | Auto-collects — no chasing |
| <b>Bank transfer</b>             | Simple one-offs                | No fees, but manual        |

**For retainers, use auto-collection** (a Stripe subscription or direct debit). You get paid the same day every month without lifting a finger — this is the secret to stress-free recurring income.

LT





## INVOICING

# Get paid on time, every time.

Clear invoicing gets you paid faster and makes you look legit. Takes minutes with the right tool — and it kills the awkward "have you paid yet?" chase.

### Invoice like a pro

- ✓ **Invoice upfront** — payment before the month's work (or 50% deposit on projects).
- ✓ **Free software** — Wave, Stripe, PayPal auto-generate invoices.
- ✓ **Clear terms** — "due on receipt" or "within 7 days", stated on it.
- ✓ **Auto-reminders** — the tool chases late payers for you.
- ✓ **Number & save every one** — you'll need them at tax time.

### What goes on it

- ✦ Your name/business & contact, an invoice number & date.
- ✦ The client, what you did, the amount & due date.
- ✦ How to pay — bank details or a payment link.

**Deposits protect you.** Always take money up front on new clients and projects — it filters out time-wasters and locks in your income.

LT





## TAX & MONEY

# Keep what you earn.

Not anyone's favourite subject — but staying on top of it keeps you free and stress-free. The basics are genuinely simple once you set them up.

### The essentials

- ✦ **Put money aside for tax** — save ~**20–30%** of profit into a separate pot as you earn. Never touch it.
- ✦ **Track income & expenses** — a free tool (Wave) or even a spreadsheet.
- ✦ **Claim your expenses** — phone, laptop, subscriptions, ring light, travel, a bit of home use — they lower your tax bill.
- ✦ **File on time** — UK self-assessment is due 31 January. Don't be late.

### When to get an accountant

- ✦ Once you're earning steadily, an accountant (~£30–£100/mo) saves you more than they cost.
- ✦ They do your tax, tell you what to claim, and free your time to earn.
- ✦ **Watch the VAT threshold** (£90k in the UK) — they'll guide you as you grow.

**Do this today:** set up a second bank "pot" and send 25% into it every time you're paid. Future-you never gets a nasty surprise.

LT





## CONTRACTS & LEGAL

# Protect yourself.

A simple contract protects you, sets expectations and makes you look serious. You don't need a lawyer for a basic one — you need the right things written down.

### Every client contract should cover

- ✦ **Scope** — exactly what's in, and what costs extra.
- ✦ **Price & payment terms** — amount, dates, method, late fees.
- ✦ **Term & cancellation** — rolling monthly, 30 days' notice.
- ✦ **Ownership & access** — who owns content and logins.
- ✦ **Approvals & revisions** — how many, and turnaround.

### Other bases to cover

- ✦ **#ad disclosure** — always label paid partnerships (it's the law).
- ✦ **Data / GDPR** — handle client logins & customer data responsibly.
- ✦ **Insurance** — professional indemnity is cheap and worth it as you grow.



Want a ready-to-use contract, invoice & onboarding pack? **DM @lou1sethomson.**

LT



A woman with long brown hair and blue eyes is posing in a black and white bikini by a swimming pool. She is looking towards the camera with a slight smile. The background shows a pool with blue water, a concrete edge, and some greenery.

MODULE 11

# Grow, Monetise & Scale

The honest version of how the money actually builds — the real 12-month story with the dips and all — then how to stack streams, land brand deals, and build income that grows even when you're not posting.

The real story

The breakdown

Income streams

Brand deals

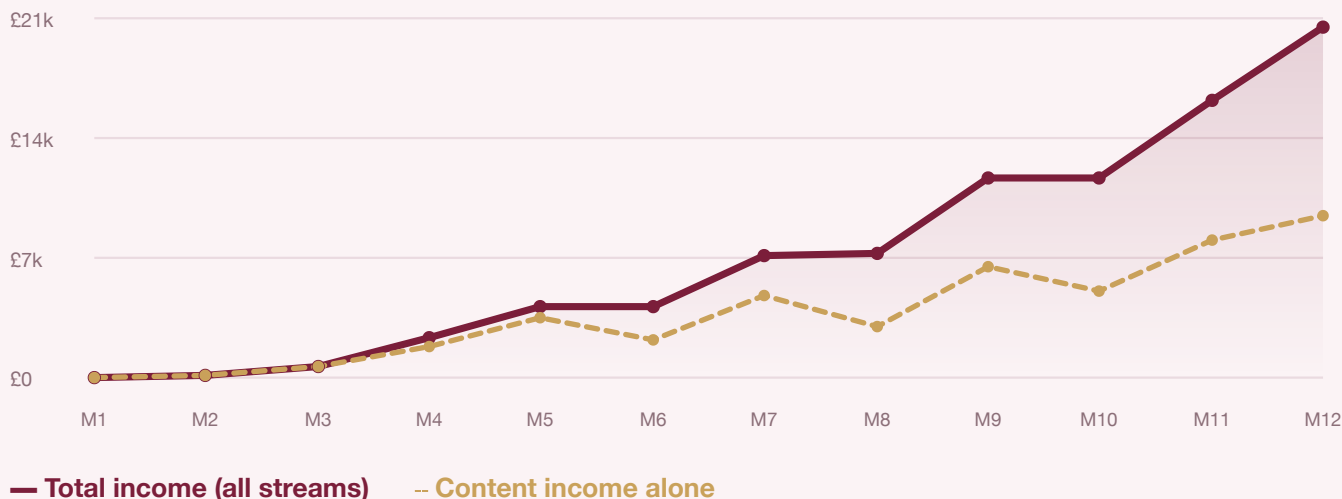
Scale



## HOW IT REALLY WENT

# £0 to £20k — the real story.

Forget the fake "straight line up" graphs. Here's how it **actually** went — messy, with real dips in the months I posted less. The gold line is content income on its own. The wine line is my **total** once I built other streams.



See the gold dips at **months 6, 8 and 10**? That's me travelling, getting busy, or just not posting enough — and content income fell hard. But look at the wine line: the **total barely flinched**. That's not luck. That's diversification doing its job.

## Why the total kept climbing

- ✦ **Content is a rollercoaster** — deals and views need you posting. Miss a few weeks and it drops.
- ✦ **So I built income that doesn't need me to post** — social media management (paid monthly either way), website builds, SEO for local businesses, and my own products.
- ✦ **Those streams are recurring or independent** — they fill every dip and stack on top.

**The lesson in one line:** don't build a bigger content income — build **more income streams**.

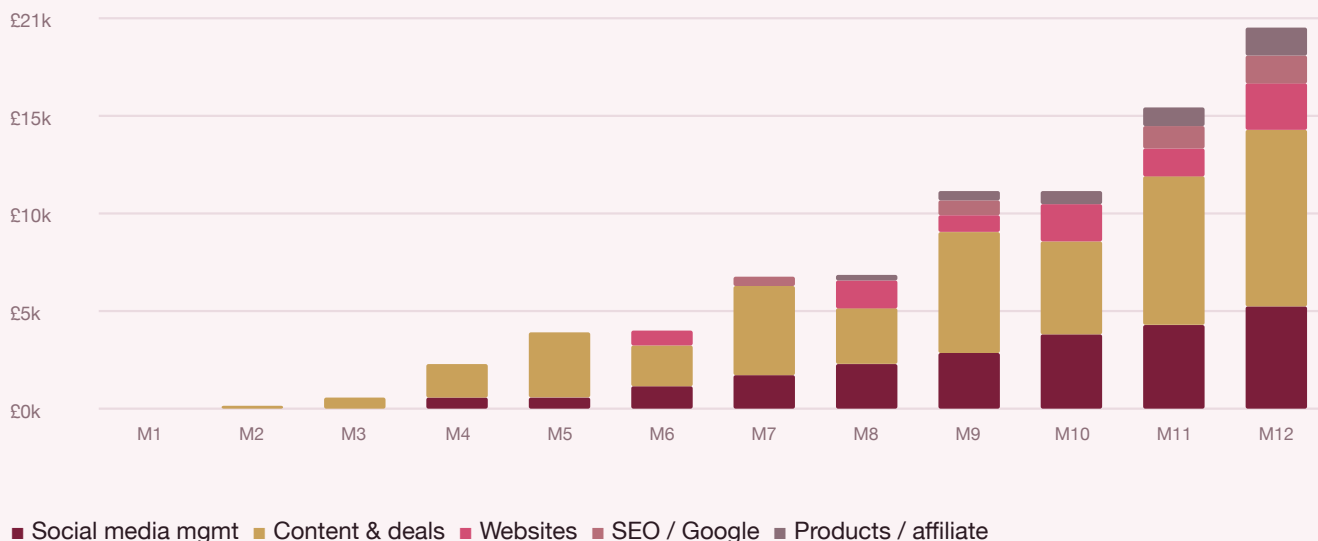
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## THE BREAKDOWN

# How the streams stacked up.

Same 12 months, broken down by where the money came from. Watch the **gold (content)** wobble while the recurring streams grow underneath it — that's what carried the total to £20k+.



## How each stream behaves

| Stream                     | Behaviour                   | Role                                   |
|----------------------------|-----------------------------|----------------------------------------|
| <b>Content &amp; deals</b> | Volatile, high ceiling      | Big wins, drops when you don't post    |
| <b>Social media mgmt</b>   | Recurring, predictable      | The backbone — paid monthly regardless |
| <b>Websites</b>            | Lumpy projects + care plans | Chunky cash + a recurring tail         |
| <b>SEO / Google</b>        | Project + retainer          | Easy add-on for local clients          |
| <b>Products</b>            | Passive, compounding        | Small, grows while you sleep           |

**Build the recurring ones first.** Management & care plans pay you on the quiet months — that stability is what lets you take swings on content without fear.

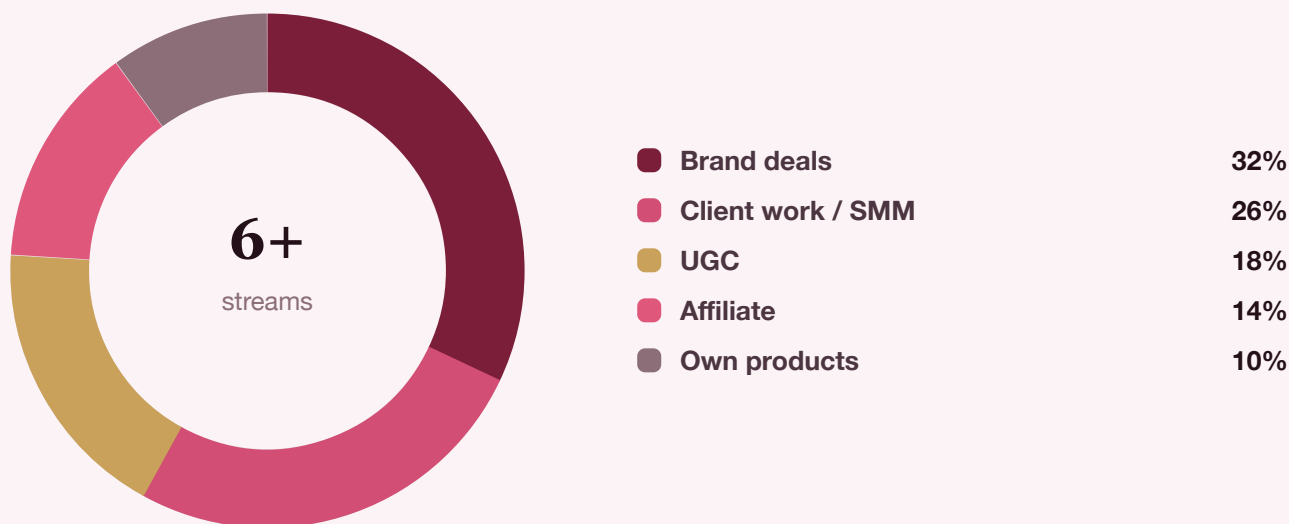




## INCOME STREAMS

# Never rely on one payday.

The creators who last don't have one income — they've got several, feeding each other. Here's the mix and roughly how it balances out for me now.



- ✦ **Brand deals** — paid posts; scale with your reach.
- ✦ **Client work** — SMM & websites; your reliable base.
- ✦ **UGC** — content for brands you don't even post yourself.
- ✦ **Affiliate** — a cut on every sale through your link.
- ✦ **Your own products** — guides, presets, courses; you keep nearly all of it.

**Add them one at a time.** Get one stream working before you start the next — don't spread yourself thin.

LT





## BRAND DEALS & PASSIVE

# Get paid — even in your sleep.

Two things here: how to land brand deals (you don't need millions of followers), and why your old content keeps paying you long after you've posted it.

## Landing brand deals

- ✦ **Tag & feature brands you love** — show them what working with you looks like.
- ✦ **Pitch directly** — a short confident email + a one-page media kit (who you are, your stats, past work, rates).
- ✦ **Know your worth** — charge per deliverable and per platform; rates rise as your reach does.

"Hi [brand], I'm [name] — I create [niche] content for [audience]. Recent posts hit [reach]. Your product's a perfect fit — I'd love to make [idea]. Media kit attached. Open to a collab?"

## Earn while you sleep

- ✦ **Evergreen content keeps selling** — a good video stays out there and people find it and buy **months, even years later**. You did the work once; it keeps paying.
- ✦ **Brands keep using great content** — if what you make performs, the brand carries on using it (and often re-books you) long after the first post.
- ✦ **Affiliate links & products** earn 24/7 with no new work.
- ✦ **It compounds** — as your audience grows, old posts reach that bigger audience too. Growth stacks on growth.

LT





MODULE 12

# Launch — Your First 90 Days

Everything so far, turned into action. The tools, a day-by-day plan to your first paid income, the numbers to actually watch, and the mistakes that quietly sink most people before they even start.

Tool stack

90-day plan

Track KPIs

Avoid mistakes



## TOOL STACK

# Everything you need (mostly free).

You can run this whole thing from your phone and a laptop. Here's the full kit — start with the free ones, add the rest only when you actually need them.

### Create

- ✦ **CapCut / InShot** — editing
- ✦ **Canva** — graphics & branding
- ✦ **Lightroom** — photos

### Manage

- ✦ **Later / Metricool** — schedule & analytics
- ✦ **Notion / Trello** — clients & content
- ✦ **Google Drive** — storage

### Get paid

- ✦ **Starling / Tide** — business bank
- ✦ **Stripe / PayPal / Wave** — invoices

### Grow

- ✦ **ChatGPT** — ideas, captions, outreach
- ✦ **Wix / Squarespace / Carrd** — websites
- ✦ **Stan / Beacons** — link-in-bio & products

**Don't buy everything.** Start with CapCut, Canva, a free scheduler, a free business bank and Wave. That's a whole business, for £0.

LT





## 90-DAY PLAN

# The exact plan.

This is how you turn the whole guide into money. Follow it and in three months you'll have posted consistently, pitched real clients, and set up to get paid.

| Phase      | Focus                                                               | Goal                               |
|------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------|
| Days 1–7   | Pick path & niche, set up profile & bio, write 10 hooks             | Ready to launch                    |
| Days 8–30  | Post daily, nail the hook, batch content                            | First content out, first followers |
| Days 31–60 | Build a brand kit & a demo site, list your packages, start outreach | First calls booked                 |
| Days 61–90 | Close your first client, deliver, get a testimonial, raise prices   | First paid income 🎉                |

### Consistency beats talent. Every single time.

The people who win aren't the most gifted — they're the ones who kept posting and kept pitching when everyone else quit.

**Do this now:** put these four phases in your calendar with a start date. Today's date. Not "next Monday."

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## TRACK YOUR NUMBERS

# What gets measured grows.

You don't need to obsess over analytics — but check a few numbers weekly so you know what's working and can do more of it.

### Your weekly dashboard

#### Reach

How many people saw you — top of everything

#### Engagement

Saves, shares, comments — quality of attention

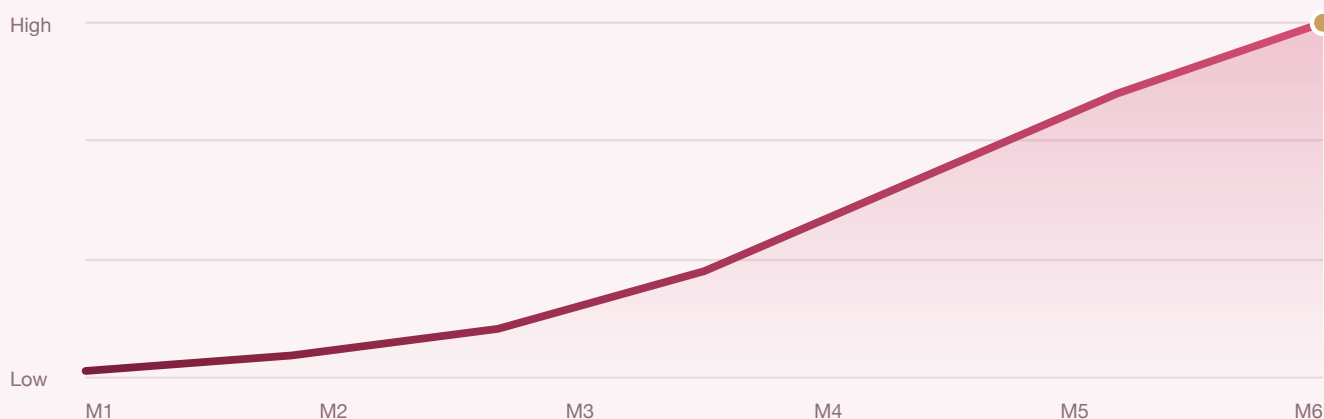
#### Followers

Growth rate, not just the total

#### Income

Leads, clients & £ — the one that counts

### 6 months of consistent effort



**It's a curve, not a line.** The first weeks feel slow — that's completely normal. Momentum compounds. Keep going and it takes off.

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## MISTAKES TO AVOID

# Don't trip over these.

Most people who quit didn't fail at the work — they made avoidable mistakes and lost heart. Dodge these and you're already ahead of 90% of beginners.

### The big ones

- ✦ **Waiting to be "ready."** Perfect never comes. Post the imperfect video today.
- ✦ **Posting randomly.** No niche, no plan, no consistency = no growth. Use a system.
- ✦ **Undercharging.** Cheap attracts nightmare clients and burns you out.
- ✦ **No contract or deposit.** Fastest way to get burned. Always both.
- ✦ **Chasing followers, not income.** A small engaged audience out-earns a big passive one.
- ✦ **Quitting at week 3.** It's always slow right before it isn't.
- ✦ **Doing everything alone.** Systemise and outsource before you burn out.

**The real mistake** is treating this like a hobby. Treat it like the business it is — show up daily, track the numbers, get paid properly — and it pays you like one.



Stuck on your next step? **DM @lou1sethomson** — one message could save you months.

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Want more, or want it done for you? **DM @lou1sethomson**

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MODULE 13

# Done For You & AI

Don't fancy doing it yourself? My team does the lot — content, management, websites, branding and full AI systems. Or learn AI directly from my engineer and become genuinely unstoppable. This is the shortcut.

[Done-for-you](#)

[Websites \(no Shopify needed\)](#)

[AI engineering](#)

[Learn AI](#)





## DONE FOR YOU

# Or... we just do it all.

This guide shows you how to do it yourself — but plenty of people and businesses would rather hand it over. That's exactly what my team's for. You focus on your life or your business; we run the rest.

### What we take off your plate

- ✦ **Content** — filmed, edited, posted
- ✦ **Full social media management**
- ✦ **Branding** — identity & templates
- ✦ **Paid ads** — set up & run
- ✦ **Websites & shops** — built for you
- ✦ **Strategy** — a plan that grows you
- ✦ **Reporting** — clear results monthly
- ✦ **Whatever you need** — just ask

**No Shopify? No problem.** Don't want to learn Shopify, editing software or website builders? You don't have to. We build and run it all — you never touch the tech.



Want it done for you? Tell us your goal and we'll build the plan. **DM @lou1sethomson** for a quote.

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## AI THAT DOES THE WORK

# A full AI engineering team.

Here's what makes us different: behind me is a **full team of AI engineers** who can build almost anything. AI isn't the future — it's how smart creators and businesses are winning right now, while everyone else is asleep on it.

### What we can build you



#### AI automation

Systems that handle the repetitive stuff — replies, DMs, scheduling, follow-up — 24/7.



#### Chatbots & voice agents

AI that answers customers, books appointments and sells, on your site or phone.



#### Custom AI tools

Content engines, dashboards, apps — built around your business.

- ✦ **Save hours a week** — let AI do the busywork so you create and sell.
- ✦ **Scale without hiring** — one AI system can do the work of a small team.
- ✦ **Be early** — most of your competition hasn't caught on yet.



Got an idea or a bottleneck you want gone? **DM @lou1sethomson** — my AI team will tell you what's possible.

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## LEARN AI DIRECT

# Learn AI from my engineer.

Want to learn this yourself and be genuinely unstoppable? You can learn AI **directly with my AI engineer** — the same person who builds our systems. It's the single most valuable skill you can pick up right now.

## What you'll learn

- ✦ **Prompting** — get world-class results from AI every time.
- ✦ **Automate your content** — ideas, scripts, captions, repurposing, at speed.
- ✦ **Build AI tools & automations** — even with zero coding background.
- ✦ **Run a business with AI** — admin, marketing, customer service, sales.

**Why it matters:** the people who learn AI now will out-earn and out-work everyone who doesn't. Learning it straight from an engineer who builds real systems is the fastest way in.

## Ways to learn

### 1:1 sessions

Personal training on exactly what you want to build.

### Group courses

Step-by-step, from scratch.

### In the Academy

AI modules built right in.



Ready to learn AI with my engineer? **DM @lou1sethomson** to join the next intake.

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Want more, or want it done for you? **DM @lou1sethomson**

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## SWIPE FILE

# Steal these — they work.

Save this page. These are plug-and-play starting points for the things you'll do most — swap in your own words and go.

### 10 hooks to open any video

- ◆ "Stop doing this if you want to grow."
- ◆ "POV: you finally..."
- ◆ "Nobody tells you this about..."
- ◆ "The fastest way to..."
- ◆ "How I went from \_\_\_ to \_\_\_."
- ◆ "I tried \_\_\_ for 30 days."
- ◆ "3 things I wish I knew before..."
- ◆ "This mistake is costing you \_\_\_."
- ◆ "Watch this before you..."
- ◆ "Save this if you..."

### Client outreach DM

"Hi [name], love what you do at [business]! I put together a couple of quick content ideas that could bring you more [result] — want me to send them over? No strings, I just work with local businesses like yours."

### Brand-deal pitch

"Hi [brand], I'm [name] — I create [niche] content for [audience]. Recent posts hit [reach]. Your product's a perfect fit — I'd love to make [idea]. Media kit attached. Open to a collab?"



Want the full templates pack — contract, invoice, media kit & 50 hooks? **DM**  
**@lou1sethomson.**

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Want more, or want it done for you? **DM @lou1sethomson**

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## RESOURCES

# Everything in one place.

The tools I actually use and recommend — most are free. Don't buy everything; start with the free ones and add as you grow.

### Create

- ✦ **CapCut / InShot** — video
- ✦ **Canva** — graphics & branding
- ✦ **Lightroom** — photos

### Plan & manage

- ✦ **Notion / Trello** — clients & content
- ✦ **Later / Metricool** — scheduling
- ✦ **Google Drive** — storage

### Get paid & run it

- ✦ **Starling / Tide** — business bank
- ✦ **Stripe / PayPal / Wave** — invoices
- ✦ **GoCardless** — retainer direct debits

### Grow & build

- ✦ **ChatGPT** — ideas & captions
- ✦ **Wix / Squarespace / Carrd** — sites
- ✦ **Stan / Beacons** — link-in-bio

**Your starter stack (all free):** CapCut + Canva + a scheduler + a free business bank + Wave for invoices. That's a whole business, for £0.

LT





**Louise Thomson**  
THE PLAYBOOK

YOU'VE GOT THE MAP — NOW LET'S WALK IT TOGETHER

# Let's do this together.

This playbook gives you the what. My Academy gives you the how — with me — step by step, with feedback, templates, and a community doing it right alongside you.



**The Louise Thomson Academy is opening soon.**

Full video training on everything in this guide — content, social media management, SEO, branding, websites, pricing, the business side and AI — plus live Q&As, a resource vault, and a bookable creator directory once you're ready to get paid. **Follow me and turn on notifications** to be first in — early members get the best price.

**Join the waitlist — follow @lou1sethomson**



Instagram — [instagram.com/lou1sethomson](https://www.instagram.com/lou1sethomson)



TikTok — [tiktok.com/@lou1sethomsonx](https://www.tiktok.com/@lou1sethomsonx)